

Bluff

YOUR WAY THROUGH

Social Networking

Poke: This is a Facebook trademark. A poke can mean anything—a way to announce your presence to friends, reminding your partner how much you miss their TLC, or just another way of saying Hi!

Wall: This is Facebook's alternative to Orkut's scrapbook with the option to send only text. This is however, not the primary means of communication. The default wall is supplanted by applications like FunWall, which is more flexible in terms of usage.

Scrap: This is Orkut's primary method of communicating with people. Members in Orkut, have an area called scrapbook where all the messages, which they have received are seen. You can send videos, animations and pictures along with plain text in scraps.

Hot list: A list of your special friends in Orkut—this is for your eyes only. A similar feature is the crush list. However, if both the persons have added each other in their crush lists, they will get a message that there is a match.

Teaser: This is a private message in Orkut, which only the recipient will see. Teasers are categorized into different moods and can be customised too, apart from the score that is provided.

Tweet: In Twitter, your update is called Tweet. It's a short message, with a maximum of 140 words.

Nudge: This is a reminder system in Twitter. If you are not updating your Twitter, you might receive a nudge from your friends. Needless to say, there is no restriction on when you can nudge someone.

Usage: Within half an hour of opening my account, I got three pokes and seven wall messages. Meanwhile, in Orkut my scraps are touching 15,000 while teasers and crush list matches from my girlfriends are filling my inbox. I have, however, yet to see the benefits of Twitter—the Tweets are too short, and I have no friends to nudge. They don't seem to like Twitter!

Wild Wild Web

In The Nudesights

What do you get when you combine Google Maps with the local knowledge of where the best peep shows are held? You get Nudar—advertised as a radar for nudity.

At <http://nudar.nudar.com> (it's not safe for work, so look before clicking), Google Maps is used to locate strip clubs, nude resorts, nude beaches, topless bars and all other similar establishments. Currently available in US and Canada, this Web site aims to map out similar places around the world.

These places can be searched based on different

categories—location, permission to serve alcohol and distance from landmarks like airports.

By simply pointing out to the location, users can rate and review them. This means that if you are in any city and want to get a bit of action—no more embarrassing questions.

For people who have GPS units, you don't have to look at the Web site. Custom made maps with emphasis on skin spots are on sale by the Web site. Buy the package for \$29.95 (Rs 1,196) and waltz across cities and alleys fearlessly, homing in with unerring accuracy.

Catty Exercises

You have a cat, and you love her to bits. You also swear by yoga and think everyone should do some *asanas* once in a while. You pamper your cat so much—it has become overweight and lazy! If you are worried that the cat could have arthritis or bad liver, go over to www.yogakitty.com and look at the videos which shows you how to do yoga with your cats. Yes, you heard right! And no, we are not delusional.

We haven't watched all the videos here (the connection was really slow) but the titles are sufficiently exotic—"Clearing past karma", "Electromagnetic Frequency", etc.

files, expecting to see something else, they were greeted with images of babies, weddings, fat ladies pushing prams, people toasting at parties or guys wearing skirts and tops. The comments in the forums revealed quite a few gems. One unlucky pirate bemoaned that instead of wasting bandwidth to download 17 GB of baby photos, he would have done better to download the real thing. Yet another stricken soul pined for image (he meant porn) detection software. The third commenter had a you-gotta-lie-in-the-bed-you-made attitude: his comment was simplicity personified—"If people want to see porn, they should download porn".

Even after people were warned that the photos were not as expected, many continued to download them. In this context, it must be mentioned

that this security hole had remained unpatched in MySpace for the last three months. Many people who continued to download them regarded this as cocking a snook at the site, and also to scare other people into thinking twice before uploading personal photos. In fact, with the rash of hacker attacks reported all over photo-sharing sites—where private or restricted photos have been accessed by outsiders—we have come to this conclusion:



PUBLICLY PRIVATE

Hole In Space

MySpace is like a big sieve where there are no secrets, even if you have used the "private" setting. It thus wasn't a big surprise when about 500,000 photos in private areas were accessed by hackers exploiting a security hole in the platform architecture. These photos totalled about 17 GB in size, and were one of the most hotly downloaded items on The Pirate Bay. At one point, about 6,700 downloads were underway at full speed, which tapered off sharply as the comments of the first downloaders started trickling in.

Most of the people who downloaded the private photos were thinking of only one thing: porn. They assumed that because it was MySpace, and because it was private, those half a million photos would be of girls in various states of undress. Sure beats having to pay sites dollars for the daily dose, right? Well not so fast, buster. As the first downloaders opened up the

no site is 100 per cent safe, and if you want to keep photos completely private, keep them on your PC. Or better yet, print them out and keep the photo album in a locked box. Hacker proof, the old way.

BUSINESS SENSE

Outsourcing Malice

Outsourcing, globalisation and catering to local needs are not only buzzwords among the legalised businesses. The villains of cyberspace—hackers, spammers, phishers and their ilk—have discovered that going local pays big time. This theory seems perfectly reasonable when the tone of the help wanted postings in underground channels—which are the cyber equivalent of seedy bars where criminals hang out—is inspected.

According to the postings, programmers with Mandarin, Russian and Portuguese skills are in hot demand. The focus is on

Bang!

February's a short month, and in general, we don't approve of it. Where did the Gregorians get off stealing our precious extra days from us? Things get extra-crazy around here anyway, but this February will go down in history...

You'd probably expect the cribbing to start right here, but some good things happened, too: Sanket bit the bullet and got himself hitched earlier in the month. Surely you'll join us in wishing the couple many years of giddy happiness.

We've also got us a new addition—Nash David has joined us as our new Copy Editor. Rumour has it that after watching us for the first two weeks, he had his head buried in his hands and was murmuring to himself "Dear God, what have I done?"

OMG! OMG!

creating sites without any typos or grammatical mistakes: too often, a fake site can be differentiated from the real goods by lousy language. Another benefit of going this route is that they can sound more genuine when they refer to something that makes more sense in local context. Because face it, if you get a long unsolicited mail offering you houses for sale on the US East, coast you

would hit the Delete button without thinking—but if that offer was for one in Mumbai, maybe you would be a wee bit more interested. Besides, knowing local conditions would make their attacks more sophisticated—it is better to spam P2P networks in Japan, gaming sites in China or banks in Brazil. The market for malicious software products in languages other than

We have plans for this one... MuwahahaHAHAHAHA.....

And now for the bad news. First, (naturally) Sanket wasn't available for work this month, so the Test Centre's job became that much tougher. The result: Raaabo's already sparse scalp even gets sparser.

Nimish was on leave too, spending time with his visiting mother. The result: Raaabo's sparser scalp starts to sweat...

And again, we must bring up the fact that February is an unacceptably short month, and we've got the Powers That Be breathing down our necks. Well, Raaabo's neck, to be precise.

Last we checked, Raaabo was roaming the streets in a daze, asking people if he could borrow a gun...

English is booming, and like any good business, the hacking networks are spreading their wings.

Will this strategy work for India? Will hackers, in the future send mails offering Pongal gift packs in Tamil, or Diwali gift certificates in Hindi? Expect to know in, like, 7 years! (Disclaimer: that figure is our guess, but don't sue us if you get cleaned out by such a rogue a few months from now).

Blog WATCH

Google's cold shoulder towards Microsoft's proposal to buyout Yahoo!, a MacBook Air user's experiences and Torrent sites being shut by media hype are part of this month's blog watch

Robert Scoble

<http://tinyurl.com/ysq3ls>

<http://scobleizer.com/2008/02/04/what-you-all-are-missing-about-google/>

What you all are missing about Google

The bloggers are going nuts, once again, over the email that a Google lawyer sent to Microsoft regarding Microsoft's proposed purchase of Yahoo.

Here's what's really going on:

1. Google doesn't mind this deal going through at all. Google knows they will be able to outrun a "Microhoo." Why do they know that? Because they've been able to outrun them both separately. As I said on Channel 5 news on Friday night: put two turkeys together and you don't get an eagle....

Enigmax

<http://tinyurl.com/2ybmof>

<http://torrentfreak.com/how-a-bittorrent-tracker-owner-hides-from-the-anti-pirates-080206/>

How a BitTorrent Tracker Owner Hides from the MPAA/RIAA

In most countries around the world, the legality of running a tracker is still uncertain, in that definitive court decisions have not been made. Even in the US, the last two big trackers to be shut down—LokiTorrent and EliteTorrents—weren't shut down by a court, but thanks

to the mainstream media, and public perception that these sites are operating illegally. The lawyers of the MPAA, RIAA and IFPI maintain they're illegal so that's often enough to cost an admin—if his identity is compromised—lots and lots of worry, and probably money too, regardless of his status under the law....

Guy Kawasaki

<http://tinyurl.com/2tc5bw>

<http://blog.guykawasaki.com/2008/02/into-thin-air-h.html>

Into Thin Air: How I Spent \$5,000 on Air and Made Fifty-Year Old Women Swoon

...Day 7: Having read all the specs and reviews about the Air, decide that this "no-compromise" machine has way too many compromises. For example, no Ethernet, no CD/DVD drive, tiny hard disk/solid-state drive (I have forty gigabytes of pictures alone), incompatible with my 30-inch Apple monitor, and a ridiculous new power supply. Therefore, order a totally souped-up MacBook Pro 15-inch.

Day 8: Entourage database corrupted for the umpteenth time. Old MacBook Pro hard disk now too small to rebuild (my email database file is 9 gigabytes). Need to do something soon. Delete to make space and rebuild Entourage for hopefully the last time.